

(it has no physical keyboard). Our model was black and had a maroon band running along its sides. Although the build of the device is almost totally plastic, it did not look 'cheap' or fragile. Like the G1, the Magic does have a 'chin' at the lower end, but it did not stick out as much as in its predecessor. Its proportions of 113 x 55.56 x 13.65 mm make it very pocket-friendly and at around 113 grams, it is on the lighter side (the iPhone 3G weighs 133 grams).

Dominating the device is a 3.2 inch (8.1 cm), 65,000 colour touchscreen (320 x 480 resolution), below which lies a trackball and six keys—*Call receive*, *Call end*, *Menu*, *Home*, *Back* and most interesting of all, *Search* (allowing you to access the search function directly). Yes, that may sound a lot in these minimalistic days when screens are followed by two or three buttons at the most, but the keys are well laid out and even with our big fingers, we never really hit the wrong key. The back of the phone is plain except for the 3.2 mega-pixel camera embedded in a small steel panel. We also noticed that unlike the G1, which had the name 'Google' on the back, this phone came with the name 'HTC' but more of that later.

Removing the back reveals a healthy 1340 mAh battery, the slots for the SIM card and the MicroSD expansion card. The sides are totally plain, barring the volume control keys on the left. No, there is no dedicated camera button, but we honestly did not miss it much. And there is no stylus either—this device is totally finger-driven. The hardware inside is pretty impressive too. The device comes with GPS, Bluetooth, Wi-Fi and about 288 MB of onboard memory (a bit less in these days of GB storage, but then it can be expanded with a 2GB microSD card that comes with the pack). Incidentally, the battery lasted us a day and a half of calling, browsing and snapping—excellent for a touchscreen device and streets ahead of the iPhone or even the BlackBerry Storm!

All in all, the Magic is not going to make users drool like the RAZR did, yet remains very flauntable nevertheless. Definitely one of the better-looking touchscreen phones in the market. And one that performs

The multi-touch factor

Multi-touch has become a bit of a rage these days, thanks to Apple's iPhone. In simple terms, this means the ability of a device to respond to more than one finger placed on the screen at the same time.

Conventional touchscreen devices recognise only one finger—so if you were to place two fingers on, say, a HTC Diamond 2's screen, it would recognise only one of them and respond to it.

Multi-touch does come with its advantages—it allows the famous "pinch your fingers to zoom in or out" that is an integral part of the iPhone, and it also adds a whole new dimension to playing games on the handset. However, so far, only two other cellphone manufacturers have followed Apple's example in this field (LG and Palm), as many of them reckon that multi-touch is more of a feel-good factor rather than a very practical one, given the hardware and software costs that will be incurred.

Interestingly, Android has support for multi-touch but so far none of the devices released on the platform have this feature.

too—the camera takes decent pictures, multimedia is handled ably, and the call reception quality is just fine, if a bit on the quiet side.

A terrific interface!

If the Magic looks good switched off, it acquires an entirely new dimension when you hit the 'On' switch (the *Call end* button does the job). The screen is brilliant and as it is capacitive rather resistive, its response is excellent—the best thing we have seen this side of the iPhone. You will need to just touch the screen lightly in most cases to get a response. Talking of responses, the device comes with haptic feedback, allowing you to feel a slight vibration every time you touch an icon or a button on-screen. We turned it off after a while but it can be handy for those new to touchscreens.



Home screen



Available applications



Browsing Google



Multi screen